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OPERATION MIDWAY BLITZ

Release doesn't mean freedom

While often framed as a victory, it is usually temporary, conditional and far from secure

By Andrew Carter, Laura Rodríguez Presa, Gregory Royal Pratt and Caroline Kubzansky
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Freddy Cazares arrived at his lawyer's office in Pilsen a few minutes early on a gray Thursday morning in August, ready to sign the documents that he hoped might provide some measure of security and peace. In the 11 months since

his detainment during Operation Midway Blitz, he'd learned to live without much of either.

His release early last December, he said, had been "like a miracle." It came after 80 days locked away, first in the Immigration and Customs Enforcement processing center in Broadview — where "they treated us worse than animals," he said — and then in a jail about 200 miles south, in rural Clay County, Indiana.

For most of his detainment, he waited to be flown out of the country. He'd signed deportation papers under duress, he said, and when agents drove him and other detainees from Broadview to an airport he waited for his name to be called. But then the plane filled and he never heard his name, and "they put us back in a van and took us to Indiana."

Almost three months later, a judge ordered his release. Cazares, 38, had been praying for it. He has

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Right: Freddy Cazares, who has lived in the United States for over 20 years, meets with his legal team at the Resurrection Project office in Chicago's Pilsen neighborhood on Aug. 6 to sign documents related to the continuation of his work permit application. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Little Big House

Northwestern's new stadium makes up for smaller capacity with premium look, feel and gives area its first architecturally distinguished playing field in over a century



Edward Keegan

Northwestern University touts its new Ryan Field as "by far the nicest stadium or arena ever built in the Chicago area."

Zachary Taylor Davis, architect of Wrigley Field and Comiskey Park, would like a word.

Hype is hype. But it's not every day that we see a new sports arena in Chicago, and the new Ryan Field is the most architecturally distinguished sports facility since those two predecessors of more than a century ago.

The new Ryan Field replaces old Ryan Field, originally called Dyche Stadium, that stood on the same Evanston site from 1926 until its demolition in 2024.

Its final cost of \$875 million is a bit more than the Obama Presidential Center, although it's considerably less than the \$2 to \$3 billion forecast for the new Bears Stadium, wherever that may eventually be built.

Pat Ryan Jr., whose family name is on five buildings at the school, including the new stadium, acted as pro-bono developer on the project. His family contributed more than half of the funds for the facility.

The complex was designed by local stalwarts Perkins&Will with Kansas City-based HNTB. New

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Top: Pat Ryan Jr., CEO of Ryan Sports Development, who is leading the development of the stadium, stands on the 50-yard line at Northwestern University's new Ryan Field on Monday in Evanston. It is still under construction and officially opens Oct. 2.

Above: Northwestern University's nearly finished Ryan Field is shown on Monday in Evanston. The 35,000-seat stadium cost \$875 million to build.

STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS

COOK COUNTY

\$191M awarded in bridge loans

Effort was meant to dull the impact of fall's property tax delay

By A.D. Quig, Claire Murphy, Evy Lewis and Christopher Placek
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Cook County Board President Toni Preckwinkle's office awarded stopgap loans to 32 villages, library and school districts worth \$191 million, an effort to dull the impact of this fall's property tax delay that nonetheless left many suburban agencies already in dire financial straits with less money than they asked for to help make ends meet.

Several officials praised Preckwinkle's efforts, and the payouts also left \$109 million in the loan pot, according to data received through a Tribune open records request.

The Cook County Board initially excluded Chicago Public Schools from the loan program but then pledged to work with the cash-strapped district if there were funds remaining after suburban applicants received their payments.

But Preckwinkle's administration suggested last week that the window has now closed, and the school district will not be able to avail itself of the unearmarked \$109

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INSIDE

High-octane offense



Are the Bears showing shades of the "Greatest Show on Turf"? A look at Mike Martz's influence on Ben Johnson's offense. Plus, the Bears face Brian Flores, the Vikings' boogeyman of the blitz. **Sports**

Fall books for 2026

Autumn is the Super Bowl of reading, a time for the big books, award-hungry novels and the Christmas-friendly celeb memoirs. **Arts & Entertainment**

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